

Reading: Summary/note/table/flow-chart completion Strategies

- Skim through the summary, note, table or flow-chart for an overview of what it is about and to understand what you need to look for.
- Go to the main text and decide where this information is.
- Read the sentence with the first gap. Underline the key words before the gap and after the gap to see what part of speech is needed.
- Scan to find the relevant section of the text, remembering that it may be a paraphrase. Look for synonyms of key words.
- Look for a word group that fits into the gap and has the correct meaning.
- Hyphenated words count as one word.
- Work through the exercise in the order of the gaps.

1. Summary Completion

- 1 In one type of summary task, you have to complete a gapped summary of part or all of the text using words from a box. The information in the summary may be in a different order from the text. There may be several words that fits the gaps grammatically, so to identify the correct one you have to read the text carefully.
 - a Read through the summary in the exam task below for general understanding.
 - b Read the sentence with the first gap carefully. Think about the possible form and meaning of the missing word.
 - 1 What part of speech is needed for question 1?
a) an infinitive b) a past participle c) an adjective
 - 2 What type of information is most likely?
a) an amount b) a change

Dinner time then and now

- A** Patterns of food consumption in Britain are changing rapidly. A major survey by research group Mintel shows that, for the first time, convenience meals account for the largest slice of all consumer spending on food – 30.1 per cent of the market. Over the past decade, pizza sales have risen by 98 per cent. Sales of pasta products have enjoyed a similar increase.
- B** But the trend has resulted in profound changes to eating habits. The proportion of adults who say they regularly eat a traditional Sunday dinner, with roast meat and vegetables, has fallen by ten per cent over the same period. Now less than half say they usually have a roast each week. Meat and fish account for a fifth of the UK's food market, but the sector has shown no growth over the past decade. Spending on fruit and vegetables, meanwhile, has gone up by only six per cent – despite a huge government education campaign to get people eating more healthily.

- C** However, the Mintel survey found that 40 per cent of the population still consider themselves as ‘traditionalist’ diners. In contrast, 27 per cent are ‘convenience seekers’, who are happy heating up meals in the microwave. A growing proportion of consumers – 31 per cent – are classed as ‘casual diners’, people who skip breakfast and eat out most nights, not for pleasure but because they can’t be bothered to cook.
- D** It is predicted that more people will become casual diners as changes in society see the size of households declining. This development, added to the increasing number of childless households, means that the pressure to cook a balanced meal has declined, Mintel suggests.

Questions 1 – 8

Complete the summary using the list of words, **A-O**, below.

In Britain, convenience meals are now the most popular type of food. Fruit and vegetable consumption has **1**-----, and consumption of meat and fish has **2**-----, but the traditional Sunny dinner is eaten by **3**----- people. Despite this, almost **4**----- the population are ‘traditionalists’ in their food habits. Just over **5**----- are ‘convenience seekers’, while almost **6**----- are ‘casual diners’. The number of casual diners is likely to **7**----- as households become **8**-----.

A smaller	B more	C older	D fewer	E a third
F half	G fallen	H increase	I risen	J remained constant
K decrease	L fluctuate	M healthier	N larger	O a quarter

2. Table completion

- A** Introducing dung beetles into a pasture is a simple process: approximately 1,500 beetles are released, a handful at a time, into fresh cow pats in the cow pasture. The beetles immediately disappear beneath the pats digging and tunnelling and, if they successfully adapt to their new environment, soon become a permanent, self-sustaining part of the local ecology. In time they multiply and within three or four years the benefits to the pasture are obvious.
- B** Dung beetles work from the inside of the pat so they are sheltered from predators such as birds and foxes. Most species burrow into the soil and bury dung in tunnels directly underneath the pats, which are hollowed out from within. Some large species originating from France excavate tunnels to a depth of approximately 30 cm below the dung pat. These beetles make sausage-shaped brood chambers along the tunnels. The shallowest tunnels belong to a much smaller Spanish species that buries dung in chambers that hang like fruit from the branches of a pear tree. South African beetles dig narrow tunnels of approximately 20 cm below the surface of the pat. Some surface-dwelling beetles, including a South African species, cut perfectly-shaped balls from the pat, which are rolled away and attached to the bases of plants.

- C** For maximum dung burial in spring, summer and autumn, farmers require a variety of species with overlapping periods of activity. In the cooler environments of the state of Victoria, the large French species (2.5 cm long), is matched with smaller (half this size), temperate-climate Spanish species. The former are slow to recover from the winter cold and produce only one or two generations of offspring from late spring until autumn. The latter, which multiply rapidly in early spring, produce two to five generations annually. The South African ball-rolling species, being a sub-tropical beetle, prefers the climate of northern and coastal New South Wales where it commonly works with the South African tunneling species. In warmer climates, many species are active for longer periods of the year.

Question 9 – 13

Complete the table below.

Choose NO MORE THAN **THREE** WORDS from the passage for each answer.

Species	Size	Preferred climate	Complementary species	Start of active period	Number of generations per year
French	2.5 cm	cool	Spanish	late spring	1 - 2
Spanish	1.25 cm	9		10	11
South African ball roller		12	13		

3. Flow-chart Completion (selecting words from the text)

- A** No treatment on the market today has been proved to slow human aging. But one intervention, consumption of a low-calorie¹ yet nutritionally balanced diet, works incredibly well in a broad range of animals, increasing longevity and prolonging good health. Those findings suggest that caloric restriction could delay aging and increase longevity in humans, too. But what if someone could create a pill that mimicked the physiological effects of eating less without actually forcing people to eat less, a 'caloric- restriction mimetic'?
- B** The best-studied candidate for a caloric-restriction mimetic, 2DG (2-deoxy-D-glucose), works by interfering with the way cells process glucose. It has proved toxic at some doses in animals and so cannot be used in humans. But it has demonstrated that chemicals can replicate the effects of caloric restriction; the trick is finding the right one.

- C Cells use the glucose from food to generate ATP (adenosine triphosphate), the molecule that powers many activities in the body. By limiting food intake, caloric restriction minimizes the amount of glucose entering cells and decreases ATP generation. When 2DG is administered to animals that eat normally, glucose reaches cells in abundance but the drug prevents most of it from being processed and thus reduces ATP synthesis. Researchers have proposed several explanations for why interruption of glucose processing and ATP production might retard aging. One possibility relates to the ATP- making machinery's emission of free radicals, which are thought to contribute to aging and to such age-related diseases as cancer by damaging cells. Reduced operation of the machinery should limit their production and thereby constrain the damage. Another hypothesis suggests that decreased processing of glucose could indicate to cells that food is scarce (even if it isn't) and induce them to shift into an anti-aging mode that emphasizes preservation of the organism over such 'luxuries' as growth and reproduction.

¹ calorie: a measure of the energy value of food

Questions 1 – 3

Complete the flow-chart below.

Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

How a caloric-restriction mimetic works

